County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, December 8, 2025
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/362917

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:14 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Joseph Passiment - Virtual at 6:36 PM
Council Member Thomas Reitz

Absent
Council Member Lawrence McElynn

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Council Member Dawson led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the minutes from November 10, 2025.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

6. Proclamation

a. Proclamation recognizing Dr. Caroline Fermin as a recipient of the 2025 Women Veteran Trailblazers Initiative Award

Chair Howard presented a proclamation recognizing Dr. Caroline Fermine as a recipient of the 2025 Women Veteran Trailblazer Initiative Award.

b. Proclamation recognizing the 50th Anniversary of Pinckney Island National Wildlife Refuge

Council Member Glover presented a proclamation recognizing the 50th Anniversary of Pinckney Island National Wildlife Refuge.

7. Administrator's Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/362917

8. Public Comment Period

Public comments were taken.

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Reitz to amend Resolution 2025/70 to extend the deadline of the appointment process to January 15, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Glover to extend the meeting past 8 o'clock.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham seconded by Council Member Brown that Council rescind the vote Council took on agenda item 13.c. of September 22, 2025, agenda which was to disapprove Ordinance 2025/44 to authorize the development agreement between Beaufort County and Pine Island Property Holdings LLC.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment. The motion failed 4:6

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/362917

10. Discussion

a. Discussion concerning a request by a County Council member to address whether signs should be place at the entryway of certain county-owned buildings to inform the public that firearms and concealable firearms are prohibited in public buildings.

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full discussion.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/362917

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Lawson to go into discussion.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Dawson to direct the County Administrator to put up signs in public business buildings and recreation buildings to inform the public that firearms are prohibited.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Member Lawson.

Abstaining: Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 5:4:1.

11. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee

1. Approval to purchase two (2) Type-1 F-450 ambulances intended to replace assets #38346 and #40272 for Beaufort County Emergency Medical Services.

2. Approval to purchase a Knuckle Boom Truck for Solid Waste and Recycling ($206,736.10)

3. Approval to Contract & Purchase Hardware, Software, and Maintenance for Beaufort County Data Center Upgrade

4. Appointment of Council Member Anna Maria Tabernik to the Beaufort Economic Development Corporation Board to fill the County Council Seat.

b. Items Originating from the Public Facilities and Safety Committee

1. Approval of a contract change order to Wood and Partners for additional permitting requirements for the Camp St. Mary's Park development project (Fiscal Impact: The original Wood and Partners contract amount was $284,150. The contract change order, including a 10% contingency, is $134,285. The original contract and change order is fully funded from account 4502-80-0000-54420, which has an available balance of $2,655,174)

2. Approval to award contract to J. Bragg Consulting for Shell Point Drainage Improvements Design, Engineering, and Permitting ($326,515.25)

3. Approval of a contract to Infrastructure Consulting and Engineering for Beaufort County 2018 Pathway Projects ($1,130,144.24)

c. Items Originating from the Community Services Committee

1. Appointment of Justin Palmer to the Disabilities and Special Needs Boards for a four-year term with the expiration date of November 2029, pending approval by the Governor's Office.

d. Items Originating from the Executive Committee

1. Appointment of Council Member Alice Howard to the Southern Carolina Alliance Executive Board to fill the County Council Seat.

2. Appointment of Christina Jackson to the Lowcountry Workforce Development Board for a partial term with the expiration date of June 2026.

3. Reappointment of Wendy Zara to the Beaufort Jasper Housing Trust Board of Directors for a three-year term with the expiration date of January 2029.

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

12. Agenda Items

a. Approval of the 2026 County Council Meeting Schedule

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve Schedule B as the 2026 County Council meeting schedule.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, and Council Member Passiment.

Abstaining: Council Member Glover. The motion failed. 4:5:1.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve Schedule A as the 2026 County Council meeting schedule.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council

Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Vice-Chair Tabernik, and Council Member Cunningham. The motion passed 8:2.

13. Resolutions

a. 2025/76: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to execute the documents necessary to negotiate with the applicant and to provide funds to the Beaufort County School District for their procurement of fee simple real property located on Lady's Island, known as the Sea Island Parkway Tracts (pin# R200 015 000 114b 0000, R200 015 000 0638 0000), with a final purchase price not to exceed the requested amount ($2,250,000), contingent upon the results of final due diligence and the School District taking ownership of the property.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on November 3, 2025 - 8:0

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/76.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

b. 2025/71: A Resolution Authorizing the Execution of a First Amended Intergovernmental Agreement (IGA) Between Beaufort County and the South Carolina Transportation Infrastructure Bank (SIB) for the US 278 Corridor Project.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:0

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/71.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

c. 2025/72: A Resolution to approve recommendations to award FY26 Community Services Grant Program funds in the amount of $398,000 to community service organizations.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:2

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/72.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Council Member Brown and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 6:2.

Vice-Chair Tabernik and Council Member Dawson recused themselves.

d. 2025/73: A Resolution approving the Beaufort County Economic Development Corporation's use $600,000 of County Site & Jobs Funds for the purchase of land on St. Helena Island for the development of a Gullah Geechee Cultural Center & Entrepreneurial Market.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on November 17, 2025 - Failed 5:5

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Lawson to defer Beaufort County Resolution 2025/73 to the February 23, 2026, Council meeting.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Member Reitz. The motion failed 5:5.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Glover, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/73.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Member Reitz. The motion failed 4:6.

e. 2025/74: A Resolution to accept a South Carolina Aeronautics Commission (SCAC) Commercial Airport Entitlement Grant ($18,455) funding for Terminal Lot Tree Removal at the Hilton Head Island Airport — CONTINGENT UPON FINAL SCAC GRANT OFFER.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:0

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/74.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

f. 2025/75: A Resolution Authorizing the Execution of a Cost-Share Agreement Between Beaufort County, the Town of Bluffton, and Buckwalter Place Association, Inc. for the Development, Construction, and Ownership of the Washington Square – Buckwalter Place Connector Road.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/75.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

g. 2025/77: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to enter into a memorandum of understanding with the City of Beaufort for collaboration on the 1st South Carolina Volunteers of African Descent Park.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on November 3, 2025 - 7:1

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Tabernik to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/77.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 8:0.

Council Member Dawson recused himself.

h. 2025/78: A Resolution approving Strategic Initiatives set by Beaufort County Council for Fiscal Year 2027.

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/78.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

i. 2025/79: A Resolution repealing and replacing Council's Rules and Procedures.

The vote at Executive Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:2.

Motion: It was moved by Vice-Chair Tabernik, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2025/79.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

14. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2025/49: An Ordinance to amend the business and professional licenses Ordinance, Chapter 18, Article III, Section 18-67(A)(B), Appendix A&B.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on October 6, 2025 - 7:0
The vote at First Reading on October 27, 2025 - 7:3
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on November 10, 2025 - 8:3

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve third reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/49.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz.

Voting Nay: Council Member Bartholomew and Council Member Cunningham. The motion passed 7:2.

15. Ordinances for Second Reading:

a. 2025/51: An ordinance to amend Beaufort County's Ordinance Chapter 102 Waterways article IV, abandoned and derelict boats, section 102-171 through 102-183.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on October 20, 2025 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on November 10, 2025 - 11:0
Public Hearing will be at Third Reading on January 12, 2026
The waterways ordinance amendment came forward to the Public Facilities Committee on September 15, 2025. The committee motioned and approved to send this item to the next Public

Facilities Committee meeting to allow additional public engagement. The item came forward again at the Public Facilities meeting on October 20, 2025. The committee motioned and approved, bifurcating the ordinance amendment to send charges to articles I, II, and III back for staff review and re-submission, and approved sending amendments to the ordinance for inclusion of Article IV forward to county council for first reading.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/51.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

b. 2025/52: An Ordinance recommending approval of the 2% State Accommodations Tax Awards as presented by the State Atax Committee.

The vote at Finance, Administration, and Economic Development Committee on October 20, 2025 - 7:0.
The vote at First Reading on November 10, 2025 - 11:0.
Public Hearing will be at Third Reading on January 12, 2026
N/A

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Cunningham, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/52.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

16. Ordinances for First Reading

a. 2025/50: An Ordinance to amend Ordinance 2022/46 authorizing the County Administrator to execute any and all documents necessary for the sale of County owned real properties identified as 1407 King Street and 600 Wilmington Street, City of Beaufort.

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on October 6, 2025 - 7:0

No motion was made to consider the first reading of the ordinance; therefore, the ordinance failed for lack of a motion.

b. 2025/53: An Ordinance Authorizing the Acceptance and Possible Eminent Domain Associated with a Drainage Easement located in Rivers End Subdivision Identified as Open Area in Plat Book 59 at page 118.

The vote at Public Facilities Committee on November 17, 2025 - 8:0

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Cunningham to approve first reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2025/53.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

17. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY

BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:

_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: January 12, 2026